

7.2 Driving, Riding And Calling

The greatest risk to a mobile phone user is an accident while distracted, particularly when driving. Don't drink and drive. Similarly, don't talk on the phone while driving. The driver talking on a cell phone need not be in an inebriated state - but he definitely is distracted. And that can mean accidents.



Obviously, the same goes for people who ride two-wheelers. In fact, two-wheeler riders face a greater risk than do drivers of four-wheelers of losing control of their bike or scooter while talking on the phone. Although a hands-free system makes things easier, it does not reduce the distraction caused by the phone call. Follow road rules while driving - your first consideration should be safety on the road.

7.3 Security Threats

Mobile spam is irritating, as you've noticed by now. Marketers are resorting to text messages to target subscribers. More and more mobile phone customers have received spam on their phones - unsolicited marketing has reached this part of the world as well. Some messages may carry viruses that could render your phone dead: mobile phones are not immune to virus threats. 'Cabir' was the first ever computer virus that infected mobile phones. For PDAs there have been Palm viruses and also infections on the Microsoft Pocket PC platform.

The earliest mobile phones did not have much security designed in. Some problems were identity theft, and "scanning" - whereby third parties in the local area could intercept and eavesdrop on calls. Although more recent digital systems (such as GSM)